JO STARKIE

SOFTWARE ENGINEERING | CLOUD SOLUTIONS ARCHITECTURE

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PROFILE

Software Engineer II at Microsoft working on Dynamics 365 Contact Center, with experience across TypeScript, C#, Azure, APIs and SDK development. Previously a Cloud Solution Architect, bringing both engineering and customer-facing experience to product development. Build customer-facing features and APIs, contribute to shared components, and investigate production issues using telemetry and debugging.

CORE SKILLS

Languages & development: C#, TypeScript, JavaScript, React, Node.js, SQL, PowerShell, Bicep.
Cloud & platforms: Azure, Dynamics 365, Azure Data Factory, Azure Functions, AKS, Microsoft Fabric, Dataverse, Power Platform, Microsoft Purview.
Engineering: API and SDK development, automated testing, CI/CD, infrastructure as code, observability, event-driven systems.
Tools: Azure DevOps, Git, GitHub, TypeSpec/OpenAPI, VS Code.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Microsoft - Software Engineer II **November 2023 - Present**

Dynamics 365 Contact Center | Voice Channel & Headless CSR SDK

- Develop features for Dynamics 365 Contact Center across voice, messaging and the Headless Customer Service Representative SDK, working primarily with TypeScript and Microsoft's Contact Center platform.
- Contribute to the development of the CSR TypeScript SDK, which allows enterprise customers to build their own Contact Center representative experiences. Delivered APIs and SDK capabilities covering conversations, presence, disposition codes, messaging and administration.
- Own investigations into customer and production issues across calling, recording, transcription, workstreams and third-party integrations. Use telemetry, code tracing and reproduction environments to trace failures through the system, identify product defects and coordinate fixes with the relevant engineering teams.
- Improve engineering quality alongside feature development by adding automated test coverage, improving SDK development tooling and sample applications, reviewing changes across the team, and maintaining onboarding and technical documentation.
- Owned the end-to-end delivery of Adaptive Card and rich-message support for the CSR SDK, enabling representative applications to retrieve and send rich content and handle customer responses. Designed the conversation-state handling and demonstrated the completed feature to the engineering team.
- Improved the design and consistency of the SDK's public APIs, including pagination, API types and usage patterns. Built and tested changes against the sample application to validate them from a consumer's perspective.
- Redesigned dialpad validation used across the main and embedded Dynamics 365 Contact Center experiences, replacing duplicated validation with a shared implementation used by agents and supervisors with voice access. Delivered and monitored the change behind a feature flag to support a controlled rollout.

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Software Engineer **January 2022 - November 2023**

Dynamics 365 | Retail & Data Platforms

- Developed features and services across Dynamics 365 and Microsoft's retail products, working primarily with C#, Azure, React/TypeScript and data services.
- Helped take the ISV Data Connector for Smart Store Analytics from private preview through to general availability. Worked extensively with Azure Data Factory, including data pipelines, validation, deployment and resolving integration issues with the ADF product team.
- Built and improved backend services for retail data processing, including event handling designed to prevent duplicate processing. Refactored existing C# services and expanded automated test coverage to improve their reliability.
- Developed and improved APIs and deployment tooling for partner integrations, including OpenAPI/TypeSpec definitions, automated security checks and configuration of services running in Azure Kubernetes Service.
- Prototyped integrations between Dynamics 365 Commerce and AI-powered shopping experiences, including indexing retail product data for a personalised shopping agent and importing Microsoft 365 content into retail catalogue experiences.
- Worked in a two-person engineering team to build and demonstrate a Retail Data Manager connector within six weeks for an NRF industry event, working through data-ingestion issues with the relevant product teams ahead of the demonstration.
- Contributed to Dynamics 365 customer-facing experiences including localisation, telemetry, customer lookup, routing and voice functionality, while also supporting code reviews, onboarding, documentation and handover between projects.

Cloud Solution Architect **September 2020 - January 2022**

Azure | Data, Analytics & AI

- Worked with customers to design Azure data and analytics solutions, with a particular focus on data warehousing and Microsoft Purview. Helped customers adopt Purview and shared their feedback with the product engineering teams.
- Built PowerShell and Bicep tools, examples and hands-on labs to make Microsoft Purview easier to deploy and learn. My PowerShell accelerator project reached 304 unique clones and 92 recorded script executions within 2-weeks of release.
- Created and delivered technical training on Azure Databricks, Git and CI/CD to around 80 Cloud Solution Architects, and helped run Power BI workshops attended by 23 people.

EDUCATION & CERTIFICATIONS

BSc (Hons) Computer Science (Artificial Intelligence) with Professional Practice **2020 alum**
Brunel University London | First Class Honours

Highest cohort GPA; Computer Science Department Award; Undergraduate Academic Excellence Scholarship for four years.

Certifications: Power BI Data Analyst Associate (DA-100), Azure Data Fundamentals (DP-900), Azure AI Fundamentals (AI-900), GitHub Foundations.

MENTORING & COMMUNITY

- Actively mentor early-career Cloud Solution Architects and aspiring Software Engineers. Co-founded UnlockHerTech and shortlisted for the WIT Summit Awards 2023. Involved in Women & Allies, Code Club, career mentoring and STEM outreach.